

First-Year Experience

FYE 101 Fall 2026

Instructor: Mark Baldridge

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Student Hours: 9am to Noon, Fridays

Class Time: 3pm Fridays

Class Place: Science Hall 251

COURSE DESCRIPTION: The First-Year Experience is a one credit-hour course designed to introduce you to the college experience—to acclimate you to life at Albright

We'll focus on

- **SKILLS:** Note-taking, study, time management, writing and other communication
- **RESOURCES:** How to use Albright's computer systems and access its many resources
- **COMMUNITY:** Student organizations and clubs, sports events and live shows, *The Experience*

Learning Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Demonstrate foundational college success skills, including project management, organization, note-taking, study strategies, and effective communication
- Apply principles of academic integrity, responsible decision-making, and digital citizenship in academic and co-curricular settings

- Develop an individualized academic and personal success plan that incorporates educational, career, and personal goals OPTIONAL TEXTS – these are Open Education Resources (OER) and free to use:

Baldwin, A. (2020). College success. OpenStax.
<https://openstax.org/details/books/college-success>

Dillon, D. (2018). Blueprint for success in career decision making. Rebus Community. <https://press.rebus.community/blueprint3/>

The semester evaluation is based on 100 points total

////TODO: Projects / Tutorials

Portfolio

You will never email or give me your assignment (unless asked, for purposes of critique) but will keep and preserve your work in a digital portfolio.

You may use a google drive — for video files, a youtube channel. Tho if you prefer ftp and Vimeo or some other combo, this is up to you!

I don't wish you to preserve your work in any space tied to your student email. I want you to have access to this material long after graduation, and indeed until you decide to archive or delete it!

If a Google Drive folder, your instructor will want it to be shared by a particular, preferred method:

LINK: [How to share a Google Drive folder with your instructor](#)

You are required to follow this tutorial if using Google Drive!

This kind of digital portfolio is only a few steps away from a professional version, useful for applying for gigs, gradschool or etc.

Your professor will always be eager and ready to help you develop a *professional* portfolio!

Details of Scale

My evaluation scale looks like this:

A grades	B grades	C grades
A+ : 98-100	B+ : 88-90	C+ : 78-80
A : 94-97	B : 84-87	C : 74-77
A- : 91-93	B- : 81-83	C- : 71-73

As this may not be a scale you've seen before, it's worth noting that:

The range of A- begins at 91 points

B- begins at 81

C- at 71

There are no gradations of the D eval, but the range is 60-70

I'm Happy to discuss my grading system, or any particular grade!

Tracking Grades

Grades will be posed to after each Project comes to completion but it's the grades (midterm and final) posted on Self Service which are considered the student's official grades

Calendar Fall 2026

WEEK	GOAL	NOTE
1. 08/24	Getting to Know You	Friday 28, last day to add or change a course
2. 08/31	Introduction to Markdown	
3. 09/07	Notetaking	
4. 09/14	Creating an archive	Friday 18, Quality/Non election ends
5. 09/21	PROJECT ONE	
6. 09/28	Introduction to Library	
7. 10/05	How to Research	MIDTERMS
8. 10/12	Generating a thesis	FALL BREAK (Monday, Tuesday)
9. 10/19	Writing an Essay	GAME JAM opens Sunday / Wednesday, Midterm grades due
10. 10/26	PROJECT TWO	Spring registration begins
11. 11/02	Project management	
12. 11/09	Kanban	
13. 11/16	Concentration	Monday 16, Last day to withdraw with W
14. 11/23	Work habits	Wednesday 25 THANKSGIVING BREAK

WEEK	GOAL	NOTE
15. 11/30	PROJECT THREE	Friday 4, LAST CLASS
16. 12/07	Graduation from FYE	FINALS WEEK

Later Dates

Last Incomplete request: Dec 14 FINAL GRADES DUE: Dec 16 Last Q/Non@
 Reversal: Jan 8 Last day to resolve "Incomplete": Feb.